

born in 1397 in Beersel, near Brussels (then in the Burgundian Netherlands). His father's identity remains unknown. Guillaume was brought up by his mother, and adopted her name of Du Fayt, later also spelled Du Fay or Dufay.



MUSICAL CODEX, 1420s

An early-15th-century illuminated page from a manuscript written by Dufay that is an important source for his early works.

While Guillaume was still a child, he moved with his mother to Cambrai to live with a relative who was a canon at the cathedral. In 1409, through this connection, he became a cathedral chorister and began his musical education in earnest. He rose through the ranks of the clergy to become a subdeacon.